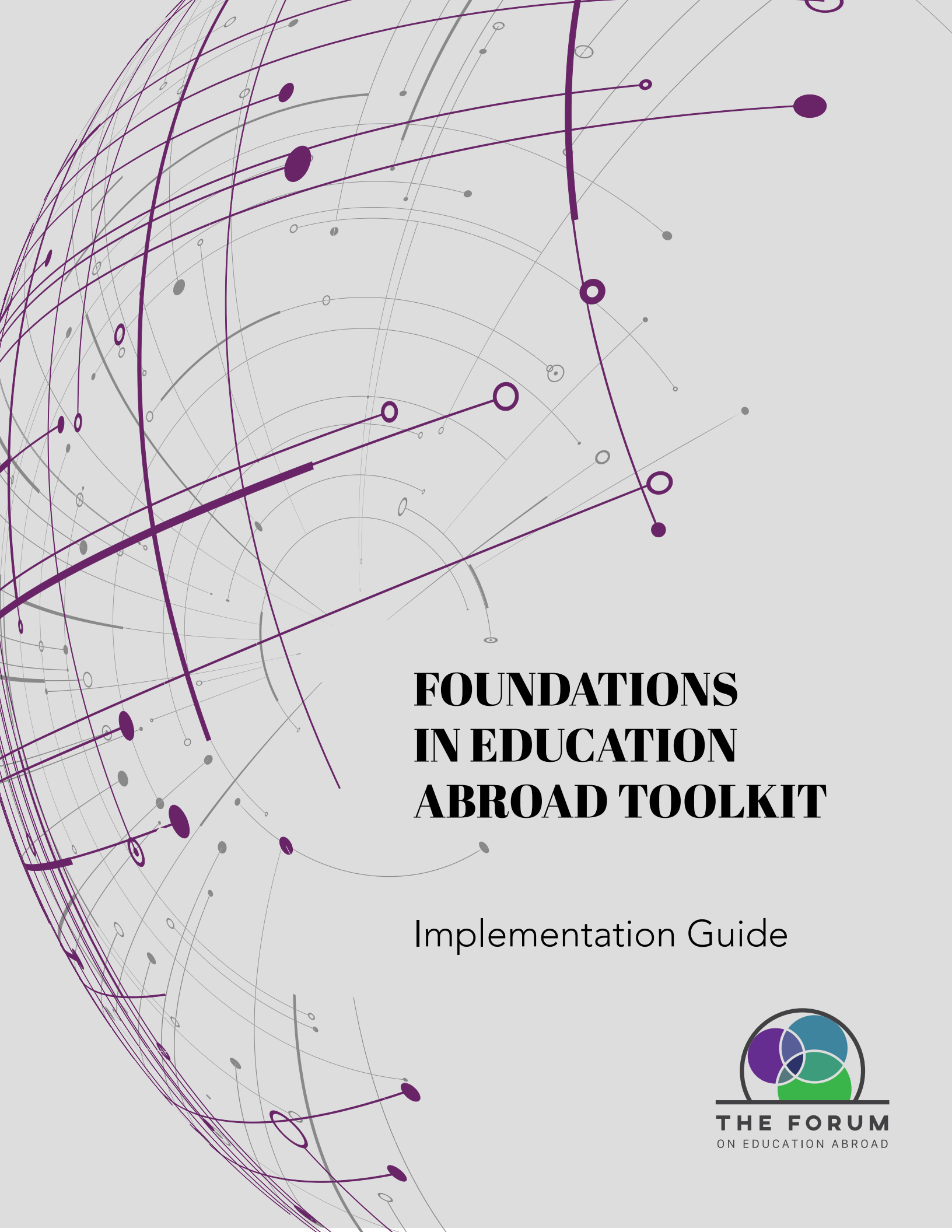




FOUNDATIONS IN EDUCATION ABROAD TOOLKIT

Implementation Guide

INTRODUCTION

Congratulations on downloading the Foundations in Education Abroad Toolkit.

The Forum on Education Abroad is excited to support the development of a comprehensive education abroad program at your institution! The Forum created this toolkit to provide education abroad offices with foundational knowledge to assist you to establish new or expand existing education abroad programming. It provides a framework for establishing effective and holistic global learning opportunities that align with institutional mission, values, learning outcomes, and curricular goals. Included are tools and resources designed to be flexible and adaptable to meet the needs of any institution. The goal is to help you build a strong foundation for education abroad that aligns with the [*Standards of Good Practice in Education Abroad*](#) and the [*Code of Ethics for Education Abroad*](#).

The target audience for this guide is education abroad administrators. This may include senior administrators, faculty tasked with oversight of education abroad, or single person education abroad offices. It is particularly useful for those working to institutionalize education abroad and those new to the field.

PARTNERSHIPS IN EDUCATION ABROAD

Foundations in Education Abroad emphasizes the importance of partnerships. Strong student-centered partnerships and collaboration with diverse stakeholders are critical to running successful programs.

In building relationships, it is important to acknowledge that each stakeholder brings unique expertise and valid perspectives. Senior administrators, organizational staff, faculty, students, parents, host organizations, community members, alumni, and employers are all critical to education abroad. We encourage you to consider these stakeholders as partners in learning. Each brings relevant knowledge and skill to developing powerful learning opportunities.

This toolkit will help you build on your campus awareness of *Standards of Good Practice for Education Abroad*. When institutions invest the time to implement the *Standards of Good Practice*, all stakeholders can benefit. This implementation guide provides a planning framework to inform conversations among all stakeholders, make the most of the toolkit resources, and build a *Standards*-based foundation upon which education abroad can thrive.

TOOLKIT RESOURCES AND HOW TO USE THEM

These tools address the foundational aspects of education abroad programming. They are intended to be adaptable to diverse institutional contexts. Most may be customized according to your institution's specific case.

1. Implementation Guide

This guide (the document you are reading) was developed to assist in building a strong foundation for education abroad that aligns with the *Standards of Good Practice in Education Abroad* and the *Code of Ethics for Education Abroad*. The target audience includes education abroad directors, faculty with responsibilities in education abroad, senior administrators, or anyone tasked with the oversight of education abroad programs. In it, you will find guidance on how to use the other toolkit resources effectively to develop your education abroad programs.

2. Prompts for Reflection

This workbook invites institutional leaders and education abroad directors to reflect on considerations key at the time of establishing or expanding education abroad programming. The Prompts for Reflection build upon selections from [*Meeting the Standards of Good Practice for Education Abroad: Prompts for Self Assessment*](#).

3. Education Abroad Program Practical Checklist

This detailed checklist includes practical components for all phases of program development and delivery that may involve various stakeholders. It is designed to be customizable for your institutional context, with fields to enter responsible parties and timelines.

4. External and Affiliated Program Approval Process and Template

A clear review and approval process enables institutions to conduct meaningful reviews of programs approved for credit and financial aid transfer. Such a process also ensures compliance with accreditation and federal funding guidelines. This resource includes a suggested process for approving external and affiliated programs, as well as an approval form template.

5. Site Visit Protocol Template

Site evaluators can use this practical tool to operate processes of systematic and comprehensive information-gathering during exploratory site visits.

6. Sample Memorandum of Agreement

This is an agreement template adaptable to diverse types of institutions and contexts. It is strongly advised that any agreements be reviewed and approved by institutional general counsel or risk managers prior to signature.

7. Marketing, Advising, and Orientation

The pre-departure phase for education abroad begins with initial communication about education abroad opportunities to students. Each communication, event, and activity should be designed to manage student expectations and prepare them for success while abroad. This resource provides general considerations related to marketing, advising, and orientation.

8. Emergency Action Planning

This resource helps education abroad offices and institutions create an emergency action plan (EAP) specific to their needs. It is important to involve key stakeholders in responding to any emergency occurring abroad and consider all potential outcomes to respond and manage impact on students, community partners, the education abroad program, and the institution. All EAPs should be reviewed with your institutional risk manager and endorsed by institutional leadership before implementation.

9. Re-Entry Programming

This resource provides an outline for education abroad administrators to intentionally integrate student education abroad experiences into academic, professional, and personal learning.

10. Suggested Readings

This is a curated list of publications and resources that provide additional context and knowledge to support program development and reform.

WHERE DO I START?

The toolkit was designed to be flexible.

We propose a method of implementation that integrates reflection and collaboration, through a comprehensive approach that covers most major components of education abroad administration. This comprehensive approach will be especially helpful for new education abroad offices and new programs.

Users at institutions with established education abroad programming may also benefit from our suggested method of implementation. However, it may make more sense for such colleagues to use the resources included in a less systematic way, to address specific and timely needs.

For all users, we suggest that you start with two critical steps.

1. FAMILIARIZE YOURSELF WITH THE FORUM'S FOUNDATIONAL RESOURCES:

[Standards of Good Practice for Education Abroad, Sixth Edition \(2020\)](#)

This document specifies minimum requirements, quality indicators, and a framework for continuous improvement for education abroad for participants from institutions.

The *Standards* can be used as a tool to:

- guide program development,
- evaluate program quality,
- advocate for resources and support,
- train new professionals,
- educate stakeholders such as parents, faculty, students, etc.; and
- establish and maintain respectful, sustainable relationships between partners.

[Code of Ethics for Education Abroad, Third Edition \(2020\)](#)

This document is designed to guide ethical decision-making and assist institutions as they seek to provide education abroad experiences and services in accord with the highest ethical standards. The Shared Values and Principles of Professional Practice outlined are essential to the fair and just administration of education abroad programs and the welfare of the learners that we serve.

Foundations in Education Abroad Toolkit Resources

This implementation guide and other toolkit resources provide more specific guidance on what it means to align your programs with the *Standards* and *Code*. Review all toolkit resources thoroughly before diving in.

2. CONSIDER THE CONTEXT AT YOUR INSTITUTION

Meeting the *Standards* will look different at different types of institutions. Set yourself up for success in implementing them in your context by reflecting on the institutional landscape:

- Who needs to be engaged in the process of building a strong foundation for education abroad?
- What are the resources available to support education abroad at your institution?
- What time of year, and length of time, will students be able to participate in education abroad? Semester, full year, summer? And at what frequency? Once, twice? As many times as they are able?
- Are there groups of students who would be excluded from participation? How can education abroad be structured to allow for every student to access education abroad?
- What challenges do you face, or expect to face, in the development and delivery of education abroad programming? What campus practices, policies, or traditions maintain these challenges?
- Who are the people with influence at your institution who would be willing to learn and help lead the implementation of education abroad programming? How can you develop relationships with these influencers to facilitate the implementation or expansion of education abroad?

- **Who are the stakeholders?** Consider the perspectives and needs of those directly and indirectly involved in education abroad:
 - University administration (including but not limited to academic affairs, finance, risk managers, registrar, housing and residence life, athletics, fraternities and sororities, student government)
 - Faculty and academic departments
 - Students (be sure to consider the needs of first-generation college students, non-traditional students, graduate and professional students, parenting students, veterans, LGBTQ+ students, students of color, international students, high financial need students, students in STEM fields, students needing accommodations)
 - Parents, families, and caretakers
 - Trustees and board members
 - Alumni
 - Prospective and current employers
 - Local and state governments and accrediting bodies
 - Others

Gather feedback from stakeholders

Take the time to learn about their values, motivations, and priorities. You might do this by holding focus group conversations, distributing surveys, or in more informal ways, like meeting one-on-one for coffee. This can help you to:

- Increase awareness of education abroad and global/intercultural learning at the institution
- Understand how global/intercultural learning is perceived relative to general education and/or disciplinary learning outcomes
- Generate enthusiasm and interest
- Help prioritize areas for improvement
- Build buy-in for the process of implementing new programs and processes

According to the feedback you have gathered, what are the challenges or pain points related to education abroad programs perceived by:

- Education abroad staff?
- Students?
- Institutional leaders?
- Faculty and departments?
- Receiving partners?

Establishing and improving education abroad programming is an ongoing process, which takes persistence. While you may have a goal of aligning your programs and practices with the *Standards of Good Practice for Education Abroad*, other stakeholders have their own goals related to financial impact, return on investment outcomes, location priorities, institutional partnerships, or other priorities. It may not be realistic to accomplish all your goals in one cycle. Instead of focusing solely on the result, we suggest you reflect on the value in the process of implementing the *Standards*, and embrace the discussions they provoke and the challenges they reveal.

ESTABLISH GOALS AND PRIORITIES

Let's consider the goals of all stakeholders, and how they intersect with the toolkit resources:

- What are your own short-, medium-, and long-term goals for education abroad programming?
- What are the broader institutional goals related to education abroad and global/intercultural learning?
- What are the academic departments' goals?
- What are the students' goals?
- How can you use the Foundations in Education Abroad Toolkit to work towards these goals?

Based on your review of the *Standards*, *Code of Ethics*, and Toolkit Resources, along with your answers to the questions above, what are the top three priorities to address this year? Sample priorities might include things like, "Implement new external and affiliated program approval process," "Develop four new faculty-led programs," and "Strengthen relationships with senior administrators."

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

- How can you use the resources provided to address these priorities?

- How will you assess/evaluate the effectiveness and outcomes of your efforts?

DEVELOP A CUSTOMIZED ACTION PLAN

Use this template to outline the steps necessary to achieve your desired results for this cycle of education abroad programming. Consider which toolkit resources correspond to each of these priorities, and which additional resources or support you might need from your institution.

Need more guidance? [Forum Consulting](#) is available to assist you and your colleagues in developing and/or executing your customized action plan, while offering recommendations tailored to your institutional culture and context.

PRIORITY 1: _____

Project Lead: _____

Team Members: _____

Desired Result: _____

Timeline: _____

Institutional Resources needed: _____

Steps to complete: _____

PRIORITY 2: _____

Project Lead: _____

Team Members: _____

Desired Result: _____

Timeline: _____

Resources needed: _____

Steps to complete: _____

PRIORITY 3: _____

Project Lead: _____

Team Members: _____

Desired Result: _____

Timeline: _____

Resources needed: _____

Steps to complete: _____

VALUE THE PROCESS, NOT JUST THE END RESULT

Effecting change at institutions of higher education is no easy task. With so many stakeholders involved, it takes time and persistence. Sometimes even simple changes may take more time than anticipated. Keep in mind that your action plan is not just a means to an end, but a catalyst for improved communication, better understanding, and stronger relationships. Be sure to:

- Approach this work with a sense of possibility and positivity.
- Celebrate wins, big and small.
- Show your appreciation for supportive partners. Ensure that there are formal mechanisms to acknowledge their achievements.
- Acknowledge that successful education abroad programming will look different at different institutions.
- Let us know how it goes!

PLAN FOR CONTINUED IMPROVEMENT

Improving education abroad programming is an iterative process. It is never complete. After working through a first cycle using the Foundations in Education Abroad Toolkit, we recommend that you pause, congratulate yourselves, and take time to reflect on your learning:

- In what ways was your approach effective?
- Was there room for improvement?
- What goals do you have in the next iteration of education abroad programming at your institution?

Consider what you have learned from:

- Debriefs with stakeholders, including external partners
- Enrollment trends
- Student learning assessment data*
- Student program evaluation survey data*

How will you continue to use the resources included in this toolkit for ongoing improvement?

*See the *Standards of Good Practice for Education Abroad* [Member Resources](#) related to Mission and Goals for guidance and best practice examples that demonstrate how to use these assessments and evaluations for continuous improvement.

ADDITIONAL FORUM RESOURCES

Education abroad programming can take many different shapes. Depending on the types of programming you offer, you might find selected additional Forum resources helpful.

The Member Resources is a collection of documents, policies, and templates that have been reviewed by The Forum on Education Abroad and professionals in the field of education abroad for alignment with the *Standards of Good Practice in Education Abroad*. Access the Member Resources by logging into The Forum Portal at www.forumea.org. These resources can serve as guidelines and templates for best practices in the field. Consider adapting pre-existing resources to meet your institution's specific needs.

The Forum's Guidelines series addresses specific program types or facets of education abroad programming:

- [Leading Short-Term Education Abroad Programs: Know the Standards](#)
- [Guidelines for Community Engaged Learning Abroad](#)
- [Guidelines for Education Abroad Advising](#)
- [Advancing the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals Through Education Abroad](#)
- [Guidelines for Best Practices in Responding to Sexual and Gender-Based Misconduct](#)
- [Guidelines for Conducting Education Abroad during COVID-19](#)
- [An Education Abroad Professional's Guide to Online Global Learning Experiences](#)
- [Guidelines for Good Business Partnerships](#)
- [Guidelines for Undergraduate Research, Field Studies, and Independent Study Projects Abroad](#)
- [Guidelines for Internships Abroad](#)
- [Guidelines for Undergraduate Health-Related Experiences Abroad](#)
- [Guidelines for Language Learning Abroad](#)
- [Guidance on School of Record Relationships for Education Abroad](#)



FORUM CONSULTING

For additional guidance on aligning your education abroad programming with the *Standards of Good Practice*, explore the range of [Forum Consulting](#) services.

Forum Consultants are available to:

- Facilitate the implementation of Toolkit resources
- Assess how well your organization is meeting the *Standards*
- Identify and prioritize areas of improvement
- Deliver customized learning and development experiences based on the *Standards*

Contact us to discuss a custom bundle to meet your needs.